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// MARKET AUDIT

Why Private Equity's AI Adoption Is Hitting a Ceiling

95%

OF FUNDS: AI MEETS OR EXCEEDS ITS BUSINESS CASE

43%

OF PORTCOS: NOT MATERIALLY DEPLOYING AI

Both numbers are true.

The tools that took over the reading have not taken over the verdict.

SOURCE: FTI CONSULTING, 2026 PE AI RADAR · n = 200

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// BOTH NUMBERS ARE TRUE

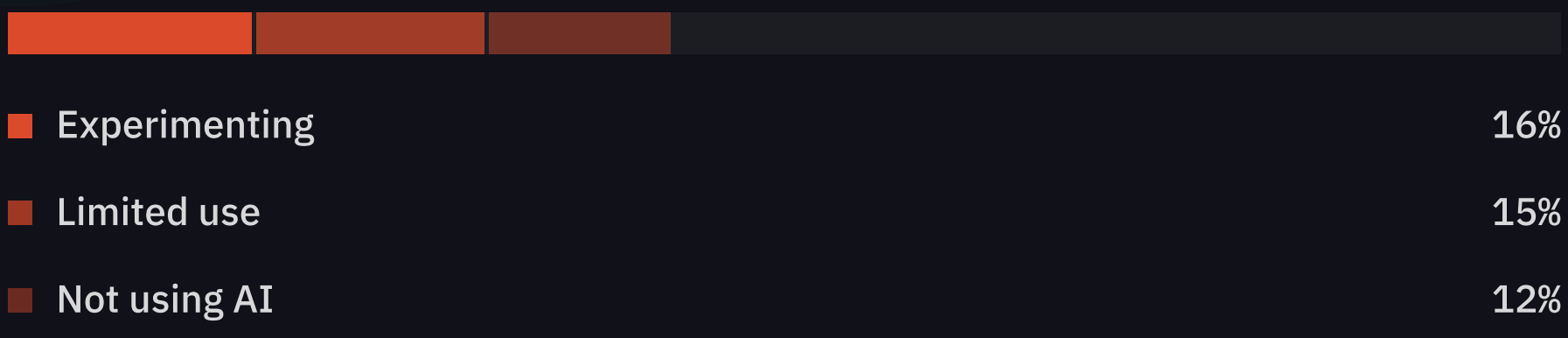
95%

OF FUNDS: AI MEETS OR EXCEEDS ITS BUSINESS CASE

43%

OF PORTCOS: NOT MATERIALLY DEPLOYING AI

THE 43%, AS FTI SPLITS IT



SOURCE: FTI CONSULTING, 2026 PE AI RADAR · n = 200 · DEC 2025

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// HOW CAN 95% BE SATISFIED?

17%

OF FUNDS SAY THEIR AI PROGRAMS
SIGNIFICANTLY EXCEEDED THE BUSINESS CASE

Most programs were designed to deliver	5–10%
The broader benchmark for AI impact	15%

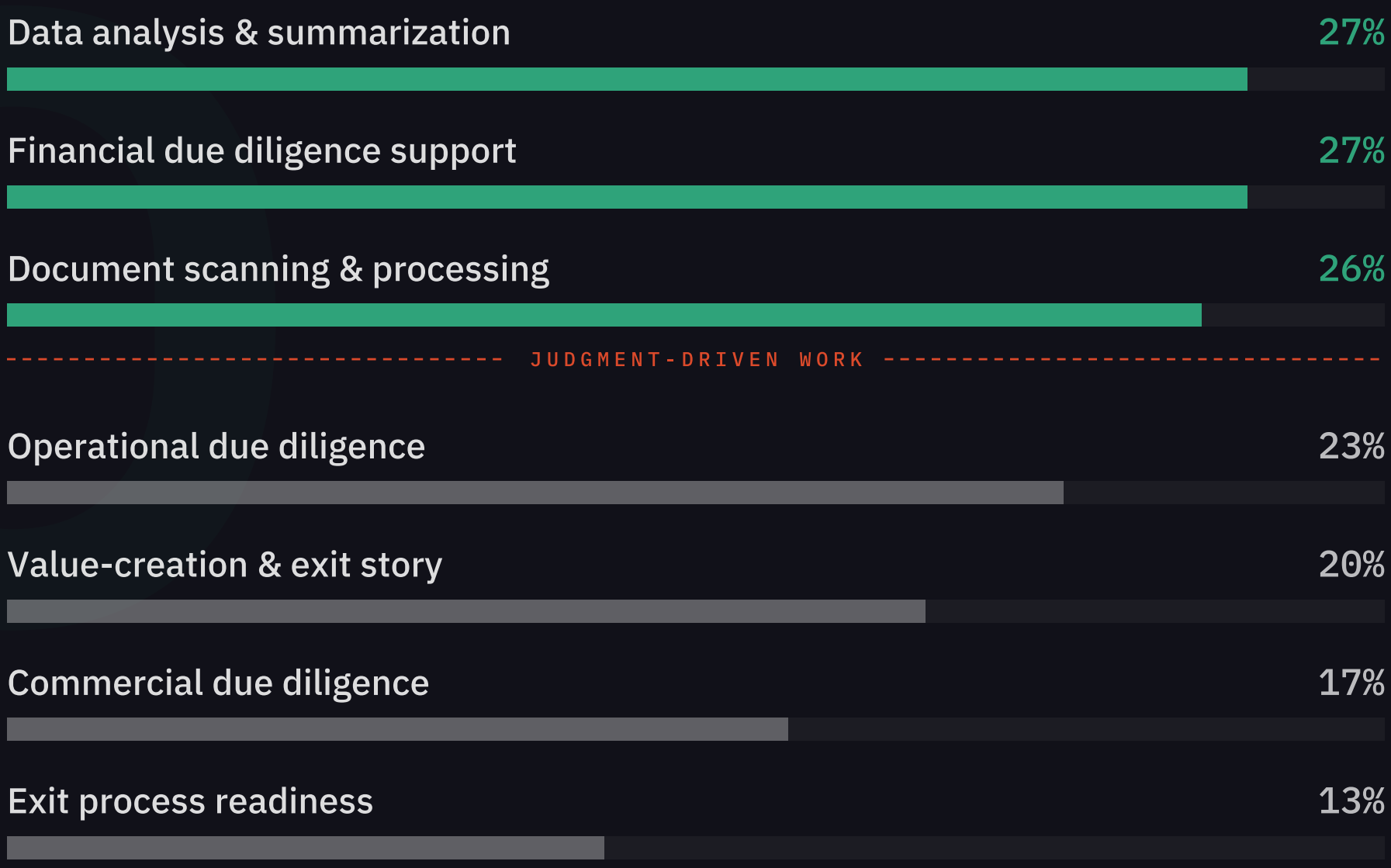
A modest target, met, reads as success.

SOURCE: FTI CONSULTING, 2026 PE AI RADAR · n = 200 · DEC 2025

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// WHERE ADOPTION COLLAPSES

AI usage by deal activity



Generative AI has absorbed information retrieval. It stalls at judgment.

FTI 2026 PE AI RADAR, FIG. 14 · 7 OF 20 ACTIVITIES · n = 200

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// AN ILLUSTRATIVE DEAL

The CIM says pricing power.
The schedules say rebates.

28%

CIM · EBITDA MARGIN
"PRICING POWER"

42%

OF MARGIN EXPANSION FROM
ONE-TIME REBATES

REBATES EXPIRE WITHIN NINE MONTHS

A language model reconciles the two.
It does not throw an error.

ILLUSTRATIVE · CONSTRUCTED EXAMPLE, NOT A REAL DEAL

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// WHY FLUENCY FAILS

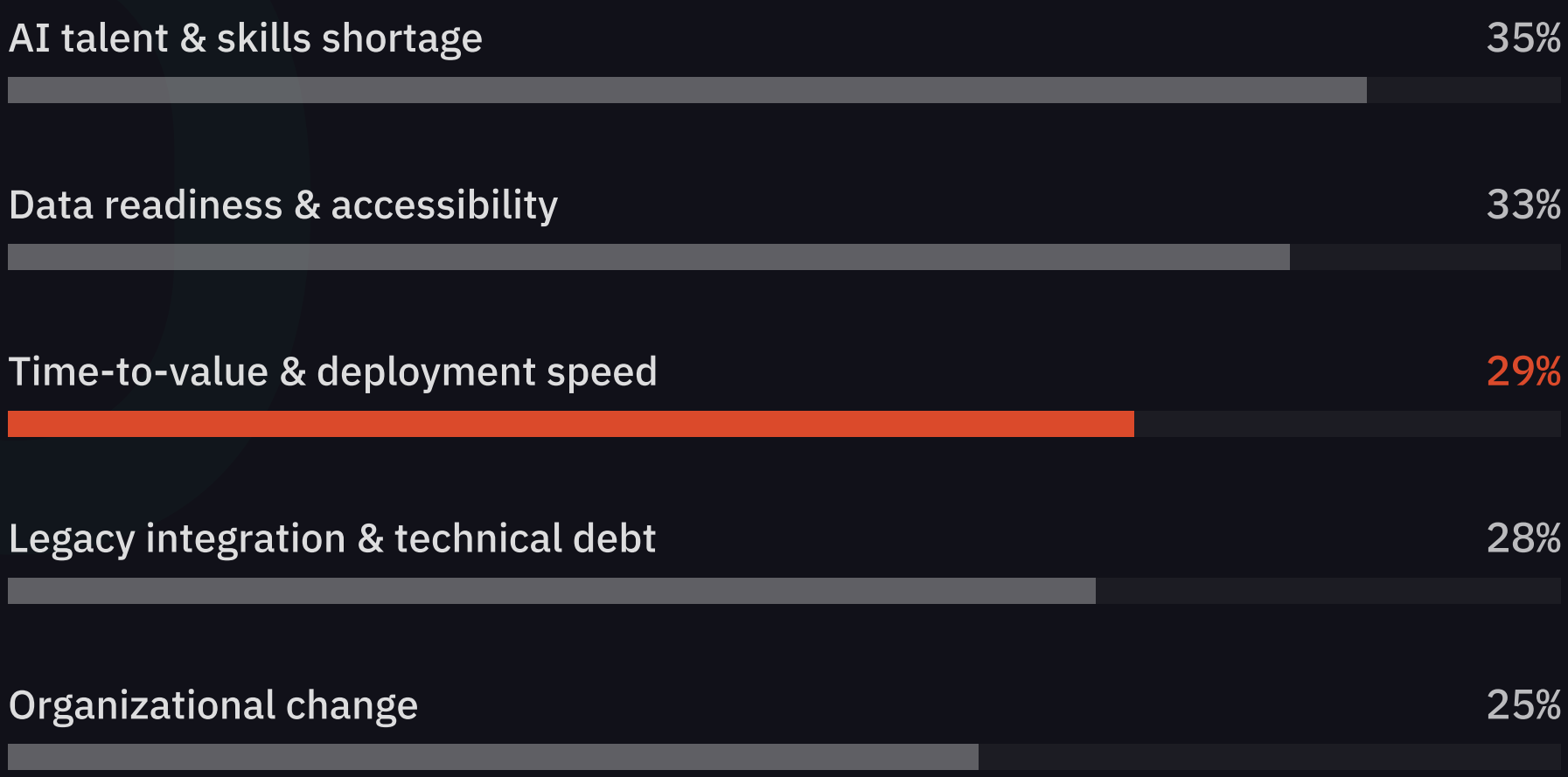
In preliminary research,
fluency is an asset.

In diligence,
it is a liability.

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// TOP BARRIERS TO SCALING AI

What stops funds scaling AI



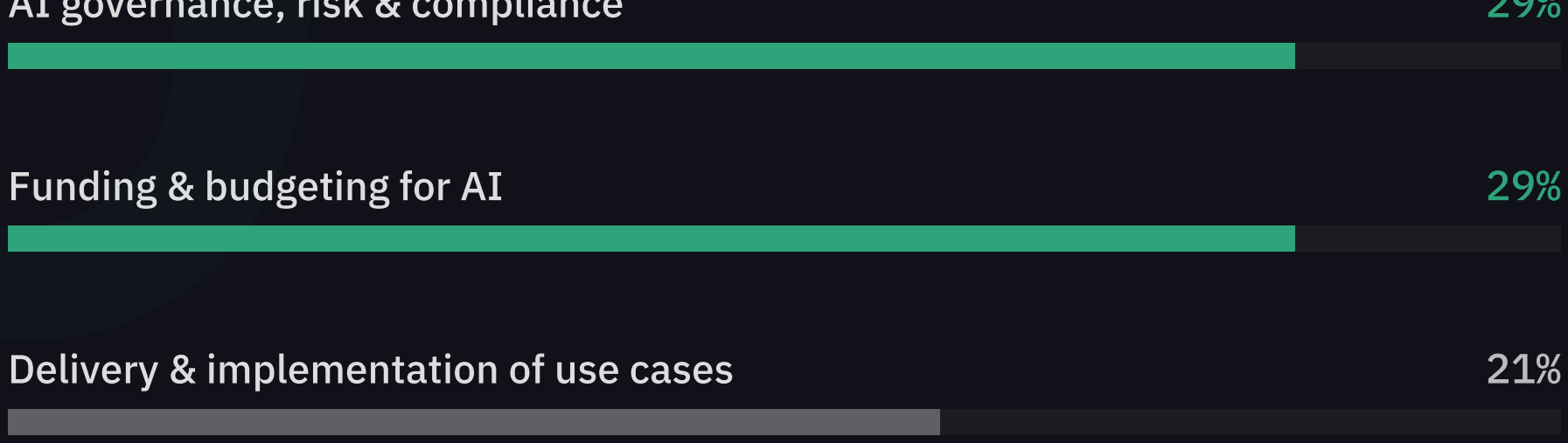
Deal work runs on a different clock.

FTI 2026 PE AI RADAR, FIG. 11 · 5 OF 10 BARRIERS · n = 200

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// WHAT THE FUND KEEPS

Risk and the money are the last things a fund lets go of.



The general partner owns the fiduciary downside.

FTI 2026 PE AI RADAR, FIG. 10 · 3 OF 9 FUNCTIONS · SHARE FUND-LED · n = 200

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// THE PE AI ALPHA TIER

+6%	+5%	+4%
ROI REALIZATION	COST SAVINGS	REVENUE GROWTH

VS. PEERS

Spending is broadly similar across tiers.

“It is not how much they invest in AI.
It is where and how they deploy it.”

— FTI CONSULTING

SOURCE: FTI CONSULTING, 2026 PE AI RADAR · n = 200 · DEC 2025

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// THE NEXT GENERATION

The first generation organized data. The second summarized text.

The funds that pull ahead will verify judgment.